

Muzhi Liu

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Education

Columbia University

New York, NY

Ph.D. in Political Science, expected May 2028

Concurrent M.A. in Statistics, expected May 2027

Selected coursework: Causal Inference, Field Experiment, Statistical Inference, Probability Theory, Bayesian Statistics, Machine Learning Theory & Application, Stochastic Processes, Game Theory, Optimization, Real Analysis, ODE & PDE, (*Planned:*) Fourier Analysis, Group and Field Theory, Topology, Algebraic Curves.

Emory University

Atlanta, GA

B.A. in Political Science, *magna cum laude*, May 2023

Research Interests

Political Methodology; Political Behavior; Public Opinion; Political Economy

Methods and Skills

Causal inference; Experiments; Text-as-data/NLP; Machine Learning; LLM-assisted measurement; Mathematical modeling and analysis

Tools: R, Python, Stan, L^AT_EX, Git, SQL, Qualtrics, CloudResearch, Prolific

Revise and Resubmit

- “Demobilization Without Backlash: Campaign Donations and the DOGE Workforce Reduction.” *Revise and resubmit at **Political Behavior**.*

Manuscripts Under Review

- “When Partisan Anchors Make Parties Legible: Transnational Partisan Generalization After U.S. Political Violence.” *Under review.*
- “Estimand-First Comparative Text Analysis: Measuring Discourse Change Across Co-Exposed Platforms” *Submitted.*
- “When Group Issues and Core Issues Collide: Evidence from Tailored Conjoint Experiments on Latino Voters” (with Yamil Velez). *Under review.*
- “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting” (with Xuan Li). *Submitted.*

Ongoing Projects

- “When Bad News Is Deniable: Holding Power and the Fragmentation of Partisan Economic Perceptions” *Draft in Progress.*
- “Beyond the Ballot Box: Campaigns and the Politicization of Everyday Consumption”.
- “Primary Election and Intra-Party Factions” (with Shigeo Hirano and Sam Frederick).

Grants and Awards

- IHS Mentorship Grant, Institute for Humane Studies, \$8,000. Summer 2026
- American Political Science Association, Spring Centennial Research Grant, \$2,500. Spring 2026
- Columbia Experimental Laboratory for Social Sciences Student Seed Grant, \$1,000. Fall 2025
- First Place, Young Public Opinion Scholar Competition, NY/PA–NJ AAPOR, \$1,000. Summer 2025

Conference Presentations

- **American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA)** Sep. 2026
 - Li, X.; Liu, M. “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting.”
 - Liu, M. “When Partisan Anchors Make Parties Legible: Transnational Partisan Generalization After

U.S. Political Violence.”

- **Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference** May 2026
 - Li, X.; **Liu, M.** “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting.”
- **Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference (MPSA)** Apr. 2026
 - **Liu, M.** “Electoral Spectators: The 2024 U.S. Presidential Election and Online Political Discourse in China.”
- **American Association for Public Opinion Research Annual Conference (AAPOR)** May 2025
 - Velez, Y.; **Liu, M.** “In Their Own Words: A Tailored Approach to Measuring Politicized Group Attachments.”

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Columbia University 2024–2026

- **Graduate courses:** Quantitative Methods IV: Advanced Statistical Modeling (Spring 2026); Quantitative Methods III: Field Experiments (Fall 2025); Math and Statistics in Political Science (Spring 2024).
- **Undergraduate courses:** Introduction to American Politics and Government (Summer 2024; Spring 2025).

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Columbia University 2023–2024

Supervisors: Robert Shapiro and Alan Yang. Public opinion and polarization projects; cleaned and merged survey datasets; implemented regression and robustness pipelines in R; produced publication-ready figures and tables.

Research Assistant, Emory University 2021–2023

Supervisors: Kiela Crabtree, Zachary Peskowitz, and Kevin Sparrow. Research on political violence and minority politics; assembled datasets from public sources; conducted literature synthesis; supported survey/conjoint design and analysis; prepared replication-ready code and documentation.

Academic Service

- Editorial Assistant, *Political Science Quarterly*. Mar. 2024–Spring 2026
- Linkage Chair, Political Science Graduate Student Council, Columbia University. Jun. 2024–May 2025
- Member, Student Advisory Board, Emory University. Sep. 2021–May 2023

Professional Experience

- Community Engagement Intern, International Rescue Committee, Atlanta, GA. Jun. 2023–Sep. 2023
- Academic Consultant and Instructor, Yuan Foundation, Washington, DC. May 2023–Aug. 2023
- Research Assistant, Ashoka, Remote. Jan. 2023–Apr. 2023